



7 Put the skewer into the solution, sugary end first, and hold it in place with a clothespin. Don't let the skewer touch the bottom. Almost at once, sugar molecules from the solution will begin sticking to the sugar granules.



8 Your solution should stay fresh for a while, as bacteria and other nasties are unlikely to survive in such a sugary liquid. But to keep out dust or insects, you can cover the glass with a piece of paper towel pushed down over the skewer.



9 Leave your glass for several days in a safe place. Check each day to see how the sugar crystals are growing. If a sugar crust grows on top of the solution, gently break this and remove it—this will help the lollipop to continue growing.

10 Once your lollipop is large enough, remove the skewer from the solution. Let the stick dry—and then enjoy the taste of your own sugar crystal lollipop. Of course, you could always wrap it and give it as a gift.

Keep your fully formed lollipops covered or in the fridge, so they stay fresh.



TAKE IT FURTHER

Instead of edible treats, you can also make exciting decorations using this same sugar-water solution, but without any food coloring. Colorful pipe cleaners have a furry texture that is a good surface for crystals to form on, and they can be bent into fun shapes!

